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From AI curiosity to capability

Building AI-ready organizations

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The rules for AI at work are being
being written now.

Are you involved in **shaping them?**
them?

Join the word cloud

When you hear “AI in the workplace,” what is the first word that comes to mind?



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The study

Employers want AI-native talent, but the workforce isn't there yet.

Indeed survey with YouGov

1,301 U.S. workers and employers · May 2026

Two terms, as the study defines them

AI native

refers to individuals who are highly skilled and comfortable with AI technologies and who fundamentally default to AI to design, execute and scale their workflows end to end.

AI fluent

refers to individuals who show mastery using AI technologies across various dimensions of their workflows but who don't always default to implementing AI over established legacy processes.

The gap is measured

52%

of workers say they are not getting the AI training they need

59%

of employers: AI-native hiring is essential

31%

expect AI fluency in most roles within two years

Fewer than

1 in 6

workers consider themselves AI-native

Indeed/YouGov, N=1,301, May 2026.

The consequences are already landing

40,000

additional applications would have advanced at an equal recommendation rate

90%

of U.S. employers use
AI screening tools

3.4M

applicants, 4M
applications, 150
employers

26% / 15%

of Black and Asian
applicants faced
adverse impact

Stanford HAI, May 2026.

Three failure patterns

1 **Tool-first thinking**

2 **Generic preparation**

3 **No operating system for adoption**

Four distinctions

Access is not adoption.

Usage is not value.

Training completion is not proficiency.

A successful pilot is not organizational capability.

Live poll

When leaders and managers are uncomfortable with AI, what is primarily holding them back?



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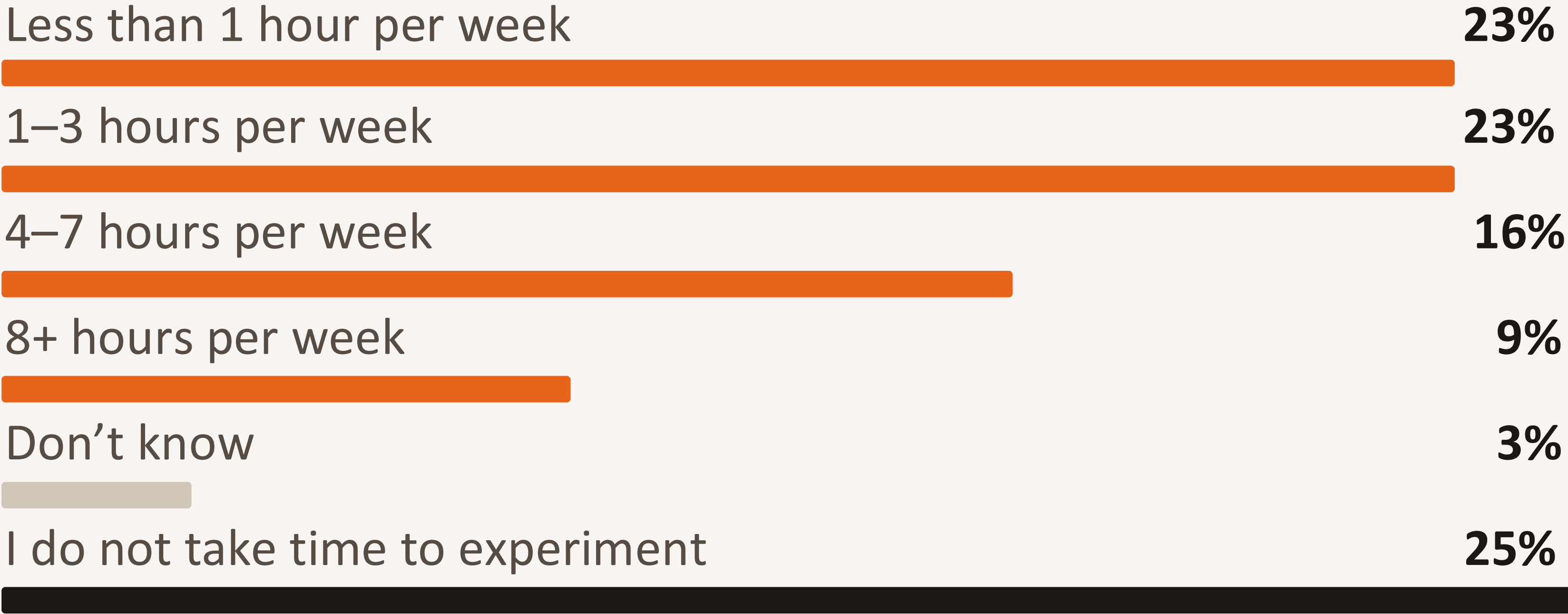
Tech capability

Mindset / Confidence

Org policies

Combination

Time spent experimenting with AI tools at work



Indeed/YouGov, May 2026. Figures may not sum to 100% due to rounding.

Manager readiness

45%

feel equipped

43%

do not

**Among managers who already lead AI-native people,
nearly 9 in 10 feel equipped.**

A capability framework

1

**Prepare the
people**



2

**Redesign the
work**



3

**Enable the
organization**



AI capability

**1 · Prepare the
people**

**2 · Redesign the
work**

**3 · Enable the
organization**

Understand → Apply → Evaluate

Anyone can generate output. Capability is knowing whether to trust it.

**1 · Prepare the
people**

**2 · Redesign the
work**

**3 · Enable the
organization**

Task

Workflow

Quality bar

Accountability

Outcome

If the workflow is unchanged, you added a step — you did not remove one.

**1 · Prepare the
people**

**2 · Redesign the
work**

**3 · Enable the
organization**

Management

Governance

Tools

Learning

Ownership

Governance on paper is not governance. Someone owns the outcome by name.

These levels do not add. They multiply.

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} 1 & \times & 1 & \times & 0 & = & 0 \\ \text{Prepare the} & & \text{Redesign the} & & \text{Enable the} & & \\ \text{people} & & \text{work} & & \text{organization} & & \end{array}$$

Any one of them at zero takes the whole thing to zero.

Every failure pattern is a missing level

Tool-first thinking

skips

2 · Redesign the work

Generic preparation

fails

1 · Prepare the people

**No operating
system**

never enables

**3 · Enable the
organization**

HR is the only function that touches all three.

Three lessons

Curiosity is abundant, capability is uneven

Generic learning creates generic results

Demonstrations inspire, practice builds capability

Learn → Practice → Apply → Feedback → Reinforce

Write down

One

workforce group

One

recurring task

One

**outcome that should
improve**

One

**decision that stays
human**

You are early

Text → Voice → Video → **Physical**

Show of hands

**How should your organization
think about AI today?**

Just another tool

New operating system

The workforce of tomorrow is
not human or AI. It is AI-
integrated.

The number we came back for

10%

of candidates who submitted four applications were rejected from all four

Pooled

across every job, adverse impact disappears

Position by position

it is there in many of them

Stanford HAI, May 2026.

HR's three responsibilities

Selection

Who gains access to work and advancement?

Redesign

How do jobs and tasks change?

Transition

How are people reskilled, redeployed, or supported?

When your organization finds an AI productivity opportunity, **who is responsible for examining the workforce consequences?**

The next competitive divide

Careless adoption

No workforce visibility

No judgment in the loop

No accounting for who is affected

Deliberate adoption

Expands human capability

Redesigns work on purpose

Creates value that reaches the people doing the work

In the next 30 days

**One workforce group. One
meaningful task.**

Resources

Learn

Dallas AI events and talks · selected books and research

Practice

labs.prismskills.ai · short exercises and responsible-use scenarios

Apply

30-day AI Capability Experiment · Workforce Capability Canvas



labs.prismskills.ai

Thank you

The workforce of tomorrow will be AI-integrated. Whether it is also **human-centered depends on choices being made right now.**



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